RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

20 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 11:51 AM, Tuesday 20 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 165 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 41 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,391 minutes at 12:00 PM (only a non-scheduled private takeoff, HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM); Dammam moving with no open halt

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,391 minutes at 12:00 PM; only movement since 9 AM was a non-scheduled private jet, HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM**.
- 165 Tuesday Riyadh flights already cancelled (28%), and NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight.
- Coalition intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh at 11:39 AM, after a Civil Defense alert for Riyadh City from 11:11 to 11:17 AM; no debris or casualties reported.
- Dammam airport moving with no open halt: 8 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9 AM, latest Gulf Air GF104 to Bahrain at 11:27 AM.
- IndiGo keeps Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Medina flights cancelled through 24 October.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12382 min).

165	1/0	5
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

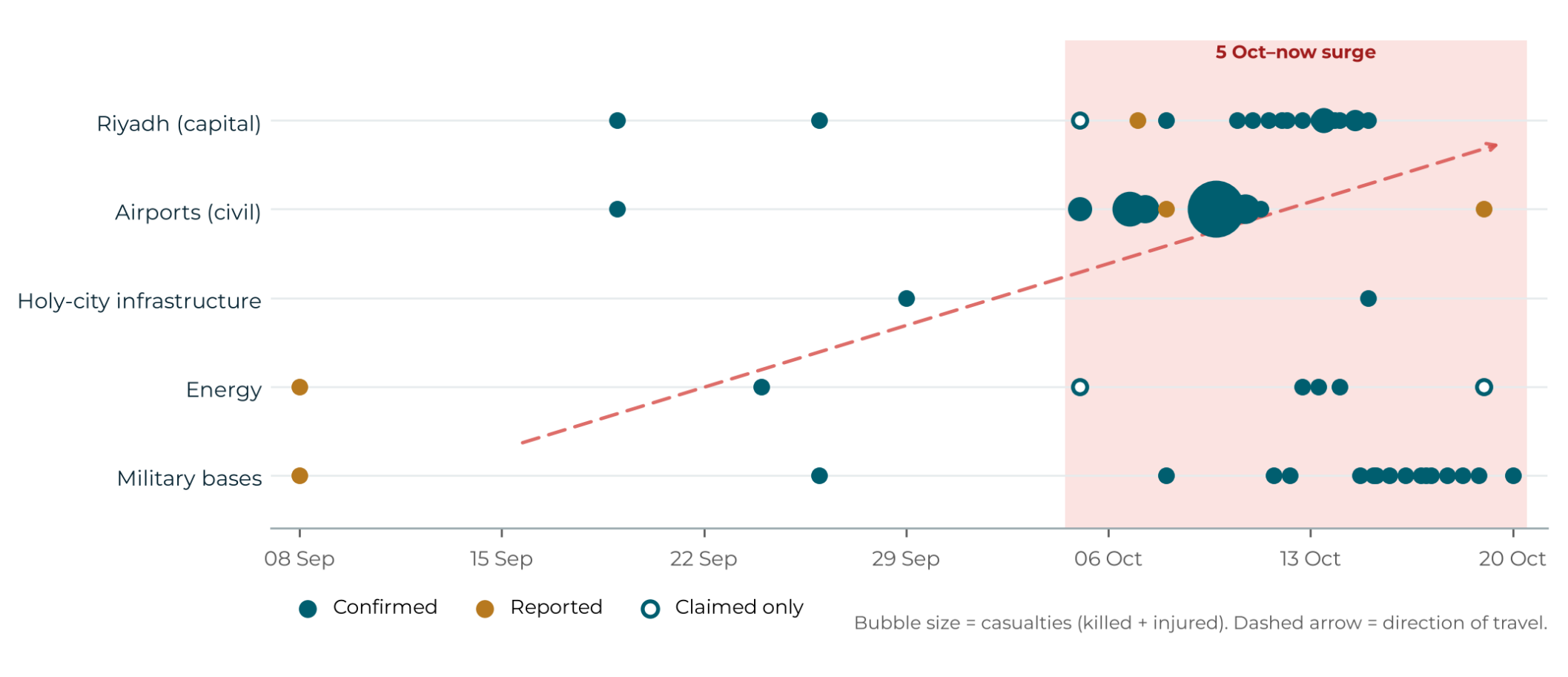
2 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

41	2/2	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (12,391 min at 12:00 PM); no scheduled takeoffs or landings since 9 AM, only private jet HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM
- Civil Defense alert for Riyadh City 11:11 to 11:17 AM; Coalition intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh at 11:39 AM, no debris or casualties reported
- Dammam moving, no halt since 8:11 AM: 8 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9 AM, latest GF104 to Bahrain at 11:27 AM
- IndiGo keeps Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Medina flights cancelled through 24 October
- Skift (Cirium): about a third of Saudi flights did not operate Monday; its report of a Riyadh reopening is not matched by the board

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 20 OCT



53 sourced events since 8 September (45 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed, after a Civil Defense early warning for Riyadh at 11:11 AM (20 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 9:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED ALERT **11:11 AM AST · Riyadh**

Civil Defense early-warning alert issued for Riyadh City through the National Early Warning Platform. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALL-CLEAR **11:17 AM AST · Riyadh**

Civil Defense all-clear for Riyadh City; danger passed, residents told not to film or share interception or impact sites. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **11:39 AM AST · Riyadh**

Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed, after a Civil Defense early warning for Riyadh at 11:11 AM. Coalition spokesman / SPA · none reported

Last 24 hours: Attacks 2, interceptions 1, alerts 4, all-clears 4.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Missile toward Riyadh intercepted after 11:11 AM alert; Riyadh airport still halted; IndiGo cancels Saudi flights to 24 Oct

Checked at 11:58 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **11:39 AM** · published 11:39 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA and Al Ekhbariya 11:41 AM; checked 11:58 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said a ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Riyadh was intercepted and destroyed. No debris, damage or casualties have been reported so far. Al Jazeera, Al Arabiya and AFP-relayed outlets carried the statement within minutes.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Riyadh City at 11:11 AM, all-clear at 11:17 AM**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **11:11 AM** · alert 11:11 AM, all-clear 11:17 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account); Al Ekhbariya relayed both; checked 11:58 AM

Civil Defense issued a warning through the National Early Warning Platform for Riyadh City, then said the danger had passed six minutes later. It again warned that filming or sharing information about interceptions or impact sites exposes people to legal liability.

CONFIRMED **IndiGo: Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Medina flights cancelled through 24 October**

IndiGo (@IndiGo6E) · **11:20 AM** · airline reply to a passenger, 11:20 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official airline account); checked 11:58 AM

IndiGo told a passenger that after assessing the situation in Saudi Arabia, its flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Medina stay cancelled until 24 October inclusive.

UNVERIFIED **Skift, citing Cirium: about a third of Saudi flights did not operate Monday; says Riyadh airport reopened Sunday**

Skift (@skift) · **9:02 AM** · posted 9:02 AM AST Tue 20 Oct; checked 11:58 AM; not matched by the Flightradar24 Riyadh board

Skift reports Cirium data showing about a third of scheduled flights from Saudi Arabia were cancelled or did not fly on Monday, down from more than half on Sunday, and says Riyadh airport reopened Sunday. The Riyadh board still shows no scheduled airline takeoff or landing since 11 October; the only movements are non-scheduled flights.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official airspace updates and check with their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **8:43 AM** · latest reply 8:43 AM AST Tue 20 Oct to a passenger (official account, Arabic, translated); same reply at 3:20 AM and 9:11 PM Mon; checked 8:54 AM

King Khalid International Airport keeps answering passengers who ask whether flights are running with the same line: follow the official authorities for airspace updates and check with the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening time for scheduled flights.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni government forces report 1,164 targeting operations against the Houthis in Yemen in 24 hours**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:18 AM** · published 5:18 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 5:50 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya, citing the Yemeni Armed Forces, reported 1,164 targeting operations against the Houthi militia in the past 24 hours as part of the "Dawn of Yemen" operations. The figure comes from the Yemeni government side and has not been independently checked.

CONFIRMED **Yemen's Presidential Council head Rashad al-Alimi asks UN chief Guterres to enforce the arms embargo on the Houthis**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:25 AM** · published 3:25 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 5:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Rashad al-Alimi, head of Yemen's Presidential Leadership Council, asked UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres to enforce the ban on arms supplies to the Houthi militia.

CONFIRMED **US State Department: US government staff need special authorization to use any Saudi airport**

US State Dept travel (@TravelGov); US Mission Saudi Arabia (@USAinKSA) · **11:17 PM** · published 11:17 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); repeated as a US Mission security alert at 12:40 AM Tue 20 Oct; checked 2:50 AM

The State Department reminded US citizens in Saudi Arabia to follow the national alerts Saudi Civil Defense sends by cellular broadcast. It said US government employees working in the Kingdom need special authorization from the Chief of Mission to use any airport in Saudi Arabia. The US Mission in Saudi Arabia reissued the same guidance as a formal security alert at 12:40 AM.

CONFIRMED **FII Institute postpones the FII10 investor conference in Riyadh to 2027**

SPA (@Spa_Eng); FII Institute; CNBC, The National · **10:49 PM** · SPA published 10:49 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); FII Institute statement and CNBC first at 6:14 PM AST; checked 11:58 PM

Saudi Press Agency confirmed at 10:49 PM that the FII Institute has postponed FII10, due 26 to 29 October at the King Abdulaziz International Conference Center in Riyadh, to 2027, with new dates to come and registrations still valid. The statement does not cite security, but CNBC, The National, WSJ and FT link the decision to the escalating Houthi missile and drone attacks, including the 10 October strike on Riyadh airport.

CONFIRMED **Coalition warns Houthis against smuggling weapons by sea in traditional boats and releases strike footage**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA; Al Ekhbariya · **10:48 PM** · Al Ekhbariya first at 9:45 PM AST; SPA story and Coalition footage 10:48 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official accounts, Arabic translated); checked 11:58 PM

The Coalition Joint Forces Command warned the Houthi militia against using traditional maritime vessels to smuggle weapons, missiles and military equipment, saying it threatens Yemeni, regional and international security and endangers civilians, and urged boat owners not to deal with the militia. It then published footage of tracking and striking smuggled weapons and vessels it says organised-crime groups used to move arms to the Yemeni coast for the Houthis.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Foreign Minister and UAE and Turkish counterparts condemn continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom**

SPA (@Spa_Eng, @SPAregions); Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **10:10 PM** · SPA Arabic 8:39 and 8:48 PM; SPA English 9:19 PM (Turkey) and 10:10 PM (UAE); MOFA posts 11:14 and 11:17 PM AST Mon 19 Oct; checked 11:58 PM

Prince Faisal bin Farhan took calls from UAE Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed and Turkish Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan. SPA says both calls condemned the Houthi militia's continued attacks on Saudi Arabia, and the Saudi and UAE ministers agreed to step up coordination.

UNVERIFIED **Tasnim: Houthi drone attack on Dammam halted the airport; Dammam board shows traffic continued**

Tasnim (Iran), relayed by FinancialJuice and CGTN · **9:33 PM** · first relayed 9:33 PM AST Mon 19 Oct; CGTN 9:38 PM; no Saudi confirmation; board checked 11:51 PM

Iran's Tasnim news agency reported a Yemeni drone attack on Dammam and said airport activity was halted. Saudi authorities have reported no attack or interception in the Eastern Region tonight, and the Flightradar24 board shows only a 35-minute gap at Dammam (9:12 to 9:47 PM) followed by normal takeoffs and landings, so no halt is recorded.

CLAIM **Houthi spokesman claims six strikes on Saudi oil sites, airports and bases in 48 hours**

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree via Saba · **7:41 PM** · statement dated 19 Oct; first seen 7:41 PM AST; TASS 8:25 PM AST; checked 8:58 PM

Saree claims ballistic missiles, cruise missiles and drones hit Aramco in Yanbu and the Shaybah oil field (causing fires), Riyadh airport, Abha airport, Khamis Mushait air base, radars and a naval camp. Saudi authorities have not confirmed any of these hits; the coalition earlier reported intercepting a Yanbu-bound missile and drones over the Riyadh and southern regions.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12382 min).

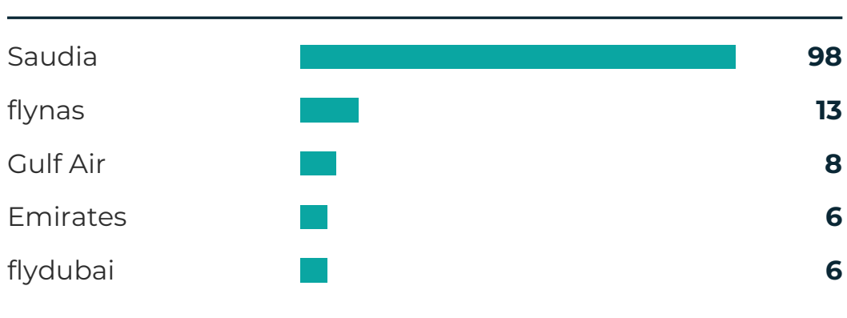
165	11:05 AM	8:43 PM	1	5
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
80 departures + 85 arrivals, 28% of 594 scheduled.	HZSK5 to Geneva (non-airline flight), 46 min before 11:51 AM.	N437GA from Athens, 908 min before 11:51 AM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam, Jeddah.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:51 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 156 at 11:52 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

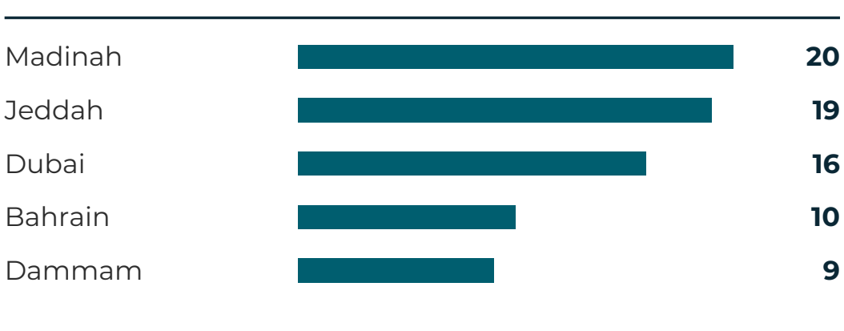
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	80	85	165	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	76 (25%)	80 (27%)	156	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	1 (0%)	1	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (100%)	3 (75%)	7	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	558 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	1 of 130	0 of 110	1 of 240	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	5	5	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	11	19	30	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	72	100	172	FR24 stats panel

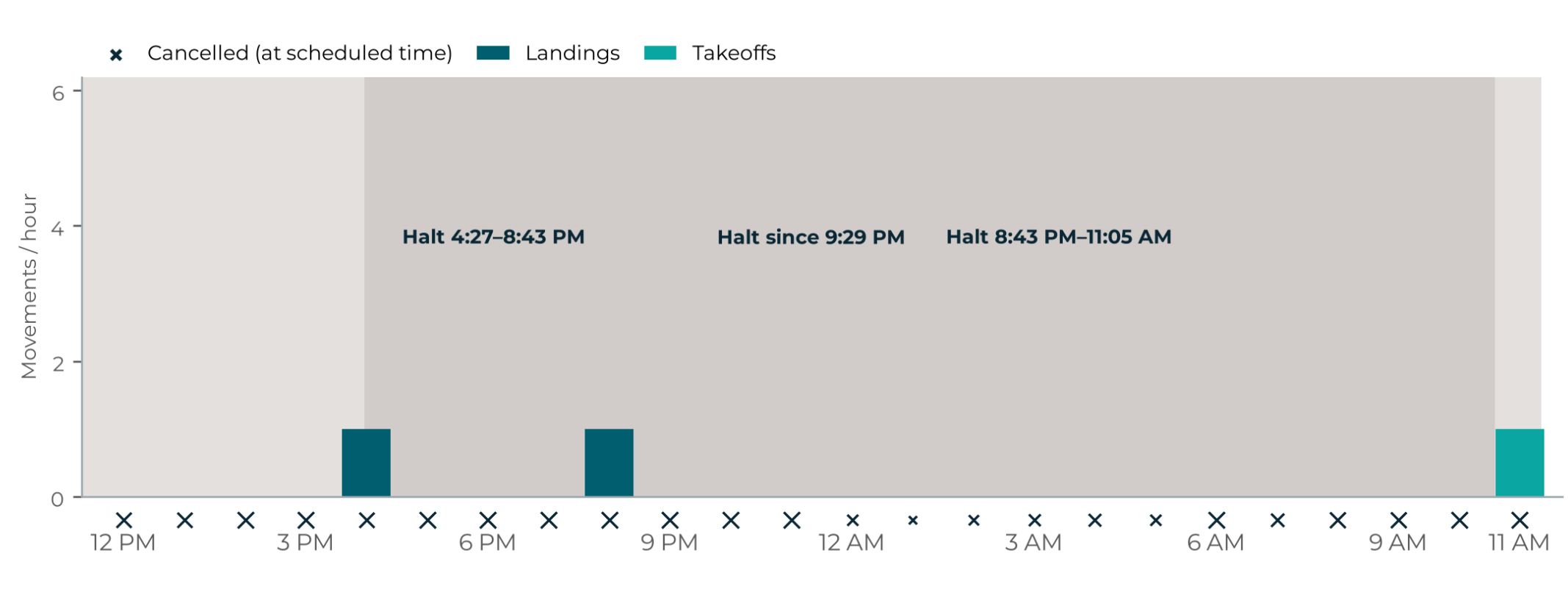
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



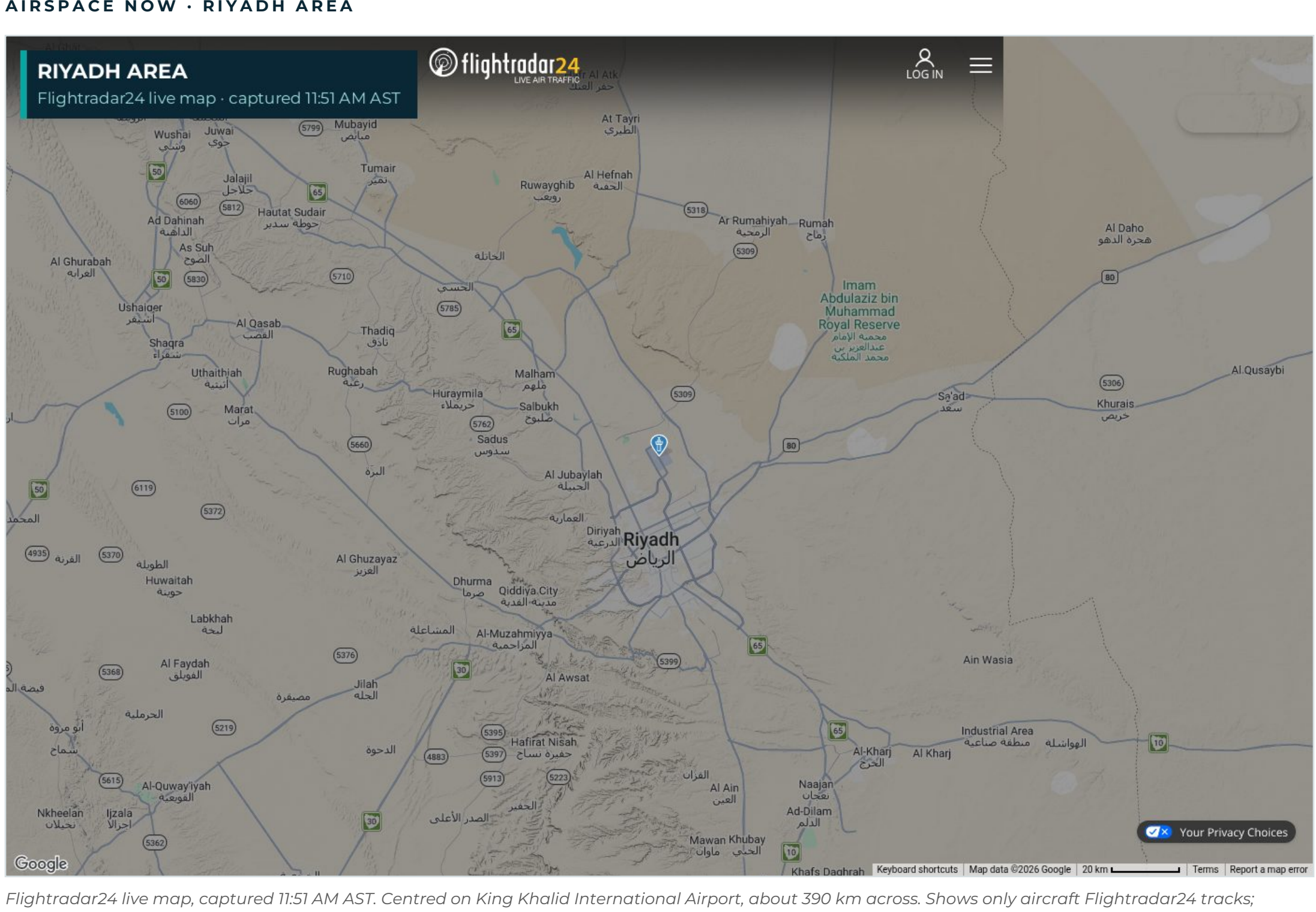
Recorded takeoffs (1) and landings (2) at RUH per hour from 12:00 PM Monday to 11:51 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are non-scheduled flights: landings SV918 at 4:27 PM and N437GA at 8:43 PM Monday, and the private-jet takeoff HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 12:41–1:48 AM, 2:04–2:53 AM, 5:15–6:17 AM and 7:13–8:11 AM Tuesday; Dammam has had no halt since 8:11 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 8:43 PM–11:05 AM	862 min
Halt 4:27–8:43 PM	256 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	12382 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:51 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

5

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 2 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

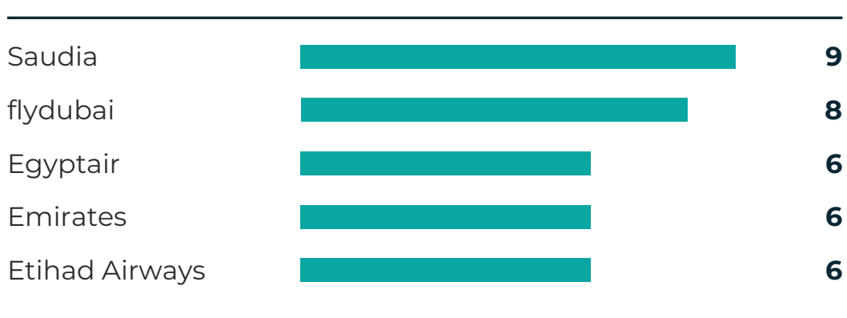
41	11:27 AM	11:25 AM	2	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
20 departures + 21 arrivals, 19% of 220 scheduled.	GF104 to Bahrain, 24 min before 11:51 AM.	XY765 from Tabuk, 26 min before 11:51 AM.	2 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:51 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 38 at 11:51 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

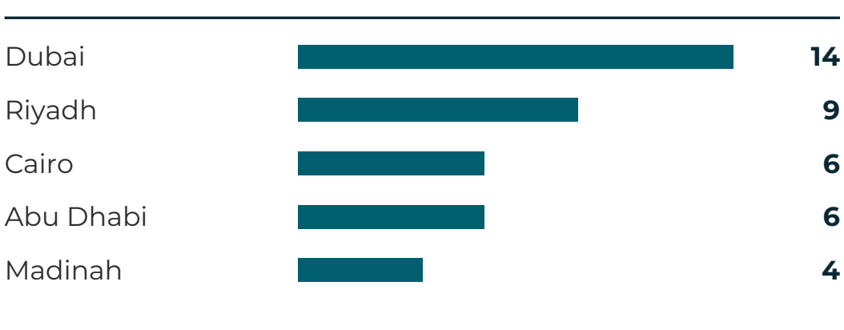
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	20	21	41	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	19 (17%)	19 (18%)	38	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	13 (12%)	7 (7%)	20	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	12 (48%)	9 (56%)	21	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	5 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	25 of 41	18 of 39	43 of 80	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	10	12	22	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	18	33	FR24 stats panel

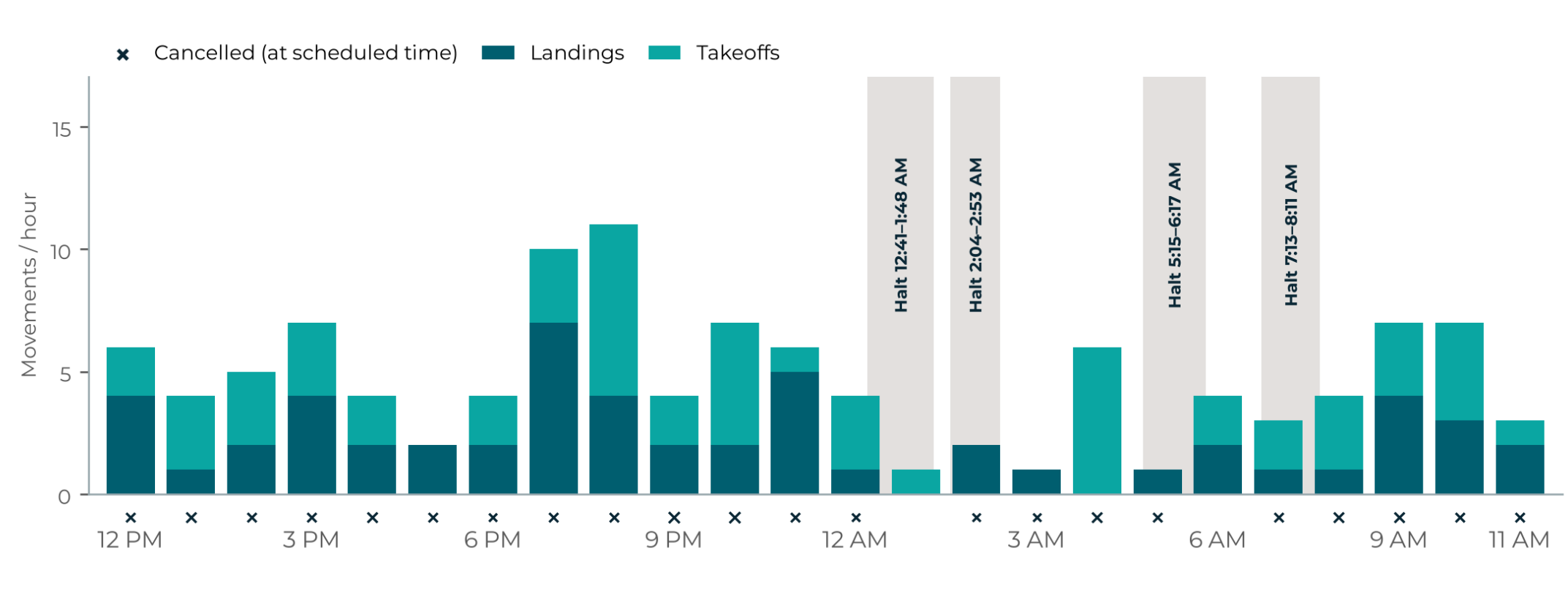
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (58) and landings (55) at DMM per hour from 12:00 PM Monday to 11:51 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving, no open halt at 12:00 PM: 2 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour; 8 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9 AM; no new halt since the last edition.

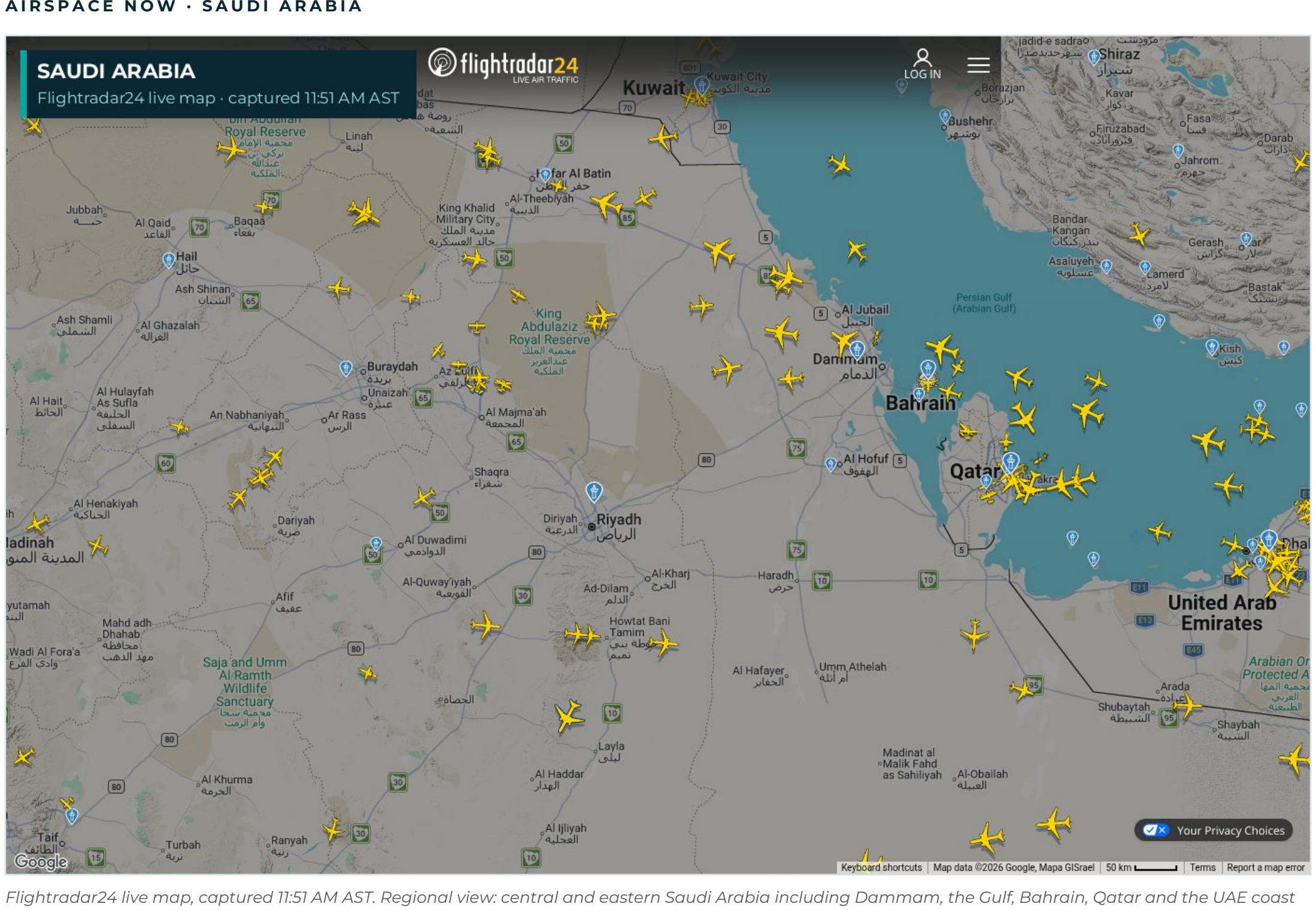
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 7:13–8:11 AM	58 min
Halt 5:15–6:17 AM	62 min
Halt 2:04–2:53 AM	49 min
Halt 12:41–1:48 AM	66 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (11:58 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:51 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

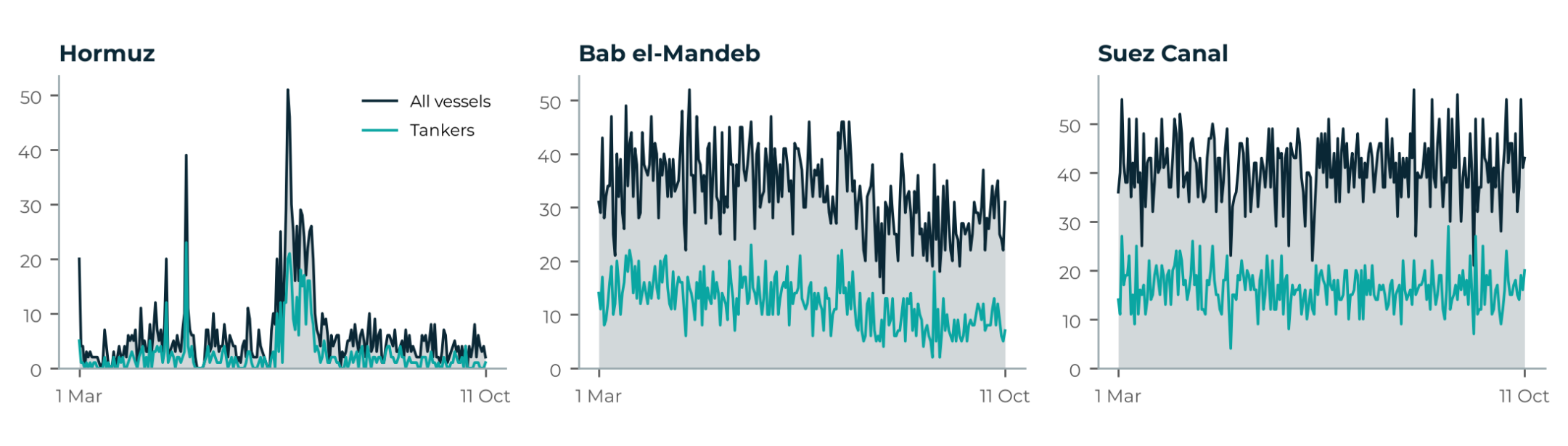
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

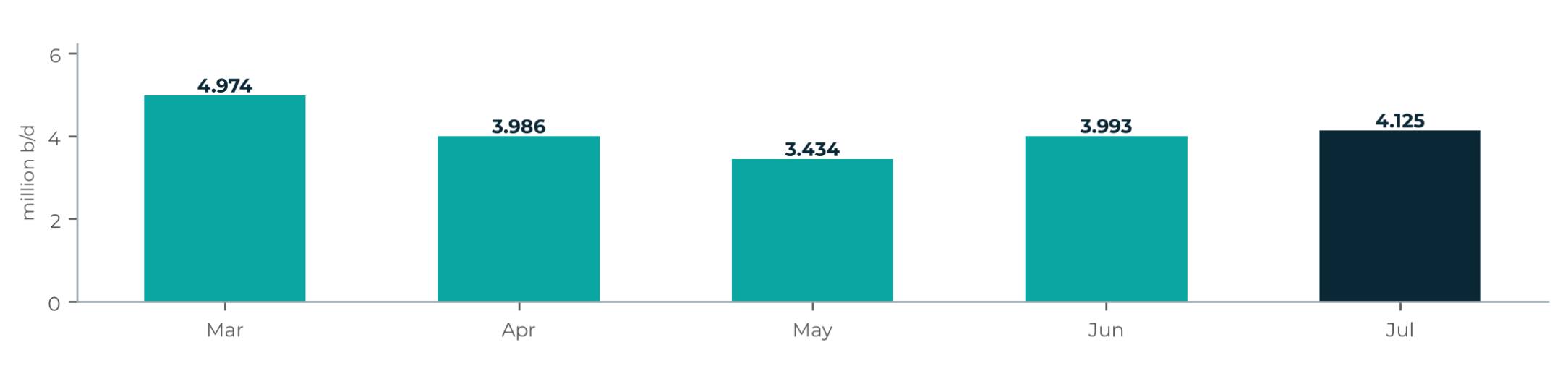
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 11:52 AM, Tue 20 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

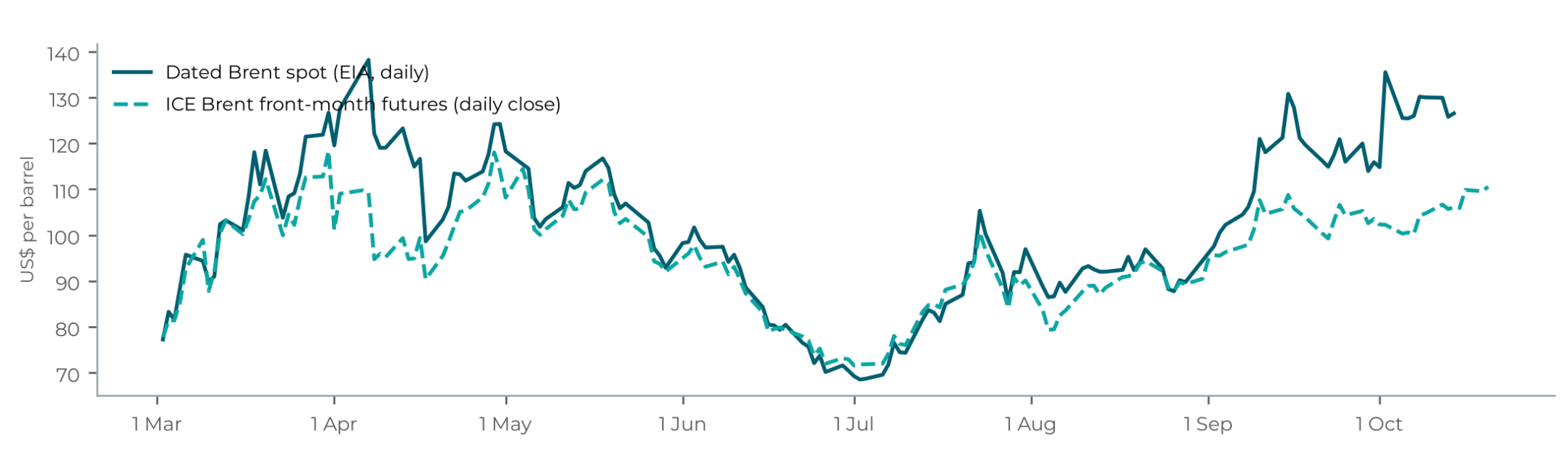


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$110.56	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:42 AM, Tue 20 Oct AST (+0.9% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 11:51 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
11:51 AM, Tue 20 Oct	11:51 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	3:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 PM